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Robot vacuum

Abstract

The present disclosure relates to a robot cleaner including a coupler provided on a rotary plate to disperse stress generated by a load and stress generated by a rotation, and the robot cleaner includes a rotary plate having a lower portion to which a mop facing a floor is coupled, the rotary plate being rotatably coupled to a body, and a coupler coupled between the body and the rotary plate, thereby preventing damage to the rotary plate by dispersing the stress generated by the load and the stress generated by the rotation.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a U.S. National Stage Application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of PCT Application No. PCT/KR2021/011621, filed Aug. 31, 2020, which claims priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2020-0082656, filed Jul. 6, 2020, whose entire disclosures are hereby incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to a robot cleaner, and more particularly, to a robot cleaner in which a coupler capable of dispersing stress generated by a load and stress generated by a rotation is disposed between a body and a rotary plate.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) Recently, a robot cleaner has been developed which performs a cleaning operation while autonomously moving in a zone required to be cleaned without a user's manipulation. Such a robot cleaner in the related art has a sensor capable of recognizing a space to be cleaned, and a mop capable of cleaning a floor surface, such that the robot cleaner may move while wiping and cleaning, with the mop, the floor surface in the space recognized by the sensor.

(4) Among the robot cleaners, there is a wet robot cleaner capable of wiping a floor surface with a mop containing moisture in order to effectively remove foreign substances strongly attached to the floor surface.

(5) Korean Patent No. 10-1903022 discloses a robot cleaner having a first cleaning module including a left spinning mop and a right spinning mop which are in rotational contact with a floor surface and moves the robot cleaner, and a second cleaning module disposed in front of the first cleaning module.

(6) In the robot cleaner in the related art, the first cleaning module and the second cleaning module are inclined downward to the left and right, such that the robot cleaner may move forward or rearward by the rotations of the cleaning modules.

(7) However, the robot cleaner in the related art has a problem in that excessive stress is concentrated on the cleaning module by a vertical drag force applied at a contact point with the floor surface, and the robot cleaner is easily damaged.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

(8) The present disclosure has been made in an effort to solve the above-mentioned problems of the robot cleaner in the related art, and an object of the present disclosure is to provide a robot cleaner in which a coupler disposed between a body and a rotary plate disperses stress generated by a load and stress generated by a rotation, thereby preventing damage to the rotary plate.

Technical Solution

(9) In order to achieve the above-mentioned objects, a robot cleaner according to the present invention may include: a body configured to define an external appearance and including a drive motor; a rotary plate having a lower portion to which a mop facing a floor is coupled, the rotary plate being rotatably coupled to the body; and a coupler coupled between the body and the rotary plate, in which the rotary plate may include: a central plate coupled to the body; a plurality of spokes radially provided along an outer circumferential surface of the central plate; an outer peripheral plate connected to the plurality of spokes and extending by a predetermined width; and a rotary shaft having one side coupled to the drive motor and the other side coupled to the central plate and configured to rotate the central plate, and in which the coupler may include: a coupling portion having a space penetrated by the rotary shaft; and support portions extending by a predetermined length outward in a radial direction from an outer circumferential surface of the coupling portion.

(10) The support portions may extend radially to correspond to the spokes.

(11) The support portion may include: a first support end extending from the outer circumferential

surface of the coupling portion and configured to be in contact with an upper portion of the central plate; and a second support end connected to an outer end of the first support end, and the second support end may be disposed to have a level difference from the first support end.

(12) The support portion may include a blade portion extending from an outer end of the second support end, and the blade portion may protrude from the second support end by a predetermined angle so as to support a protruding projection of the central plate.

(13) The second support end may be inclined downward from the first support end.

(14) The support portions may be provided in the form of a plurality of flat plates each having a width that decreases outward in the radial direction.

(15) The coupler may further include a close-contact portion extending by a predetermined length downward from an inner end that defines an internal space of the coupling portion.

(16) The close-contact portion may be in surface contact with an outer circumferential surface of the rotary shaft.

(17) The close-contact portion may include a plurality of flat springs extending downward.

(18) The plurality of flat springs of the close-contact portion may be disposed to be spaced apart from one another at predetermined intervals.

Advantageous Effect

(19) First, according to the robot cleaner according to the present disclosure described above, the coupler is provided between the body and the rotary plate and disperses the stress generated by the load and the stress generated by the rotation, thereby preventing damage to the rotary plate.

(20) Second, the close contact between the rotary shaft and the central plate is maintained by the shape characteristics of the close-contact portion and the support portions of the coupler, thereby mitigating the movement of the rotary plate.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a robot cleaner according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a view illustrating some components separated from the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is a rear view illustrating the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 4 is a view illustrating some components separated from the robot cleaner illustrated in FIG. 3.

(5) FIG. 5 is a bottom plan view illustrating the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from below.

(6) FIG. 6 is an exploded perspective view illustrating the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a robot cleaner and components of the robot cleaner according to still another embodiment of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 8 is a perspective view illustrating a separated structure of a first coupler included in the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 9 is a cross-sectional view illustrating the first coupler included in the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from one side.

(10) FIG. 10 is a view illustrating the first coupler included in the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from above.

(11) FIG. 11 is an exploded perspective view illustrating a separated structure in which a first rotary plate and the first coupler according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled.

(12) FIG. 12 is a view illustrating a structure in which the first rotary plate and the first coupler according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled when viewed from above.

(13) FIG. 13 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a structure in which the first rotary plate, the first coupler, and a first mop according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled when viewed from one side.

(14) FIG. 14 is a partial cross-sectional view illustrating an enlarged part in which the first rotary plate and the first coupler according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled.

(15) FIGS. 15A and 15B are partial cross-sectional views illustrating states before and after the first coupler and the first rotary plate according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled.

MODE FOR INVENTION

(16) Hereinafter, exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(17) The present disclosure may be variously modified and may have various embodiments, and particular embodiments illustrated in the drawings will be specifically described below. The description of the embodiments is not intended to limit the present disclosure to the particular embodiments, but it should be interpreted that the present disclosure is to cover all modifications, equivalents and alternatives falling within the spirit and technical scope of the present disclosure.

(18) In the description of the present disclosure, the terms such as “first” and “second” may be used to describe various components, but the components should not be limited by the terms. These terms are used only to distinguish one component from another component. For example, a first component may be named a second component, and similarly, the second component may also be named the first component, without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

(19) The term “and/or” includes any and all combinations of a plurality of the related and listed items.

(20) When one component is described as being “coupled” or “connected” to another component, it should be understood that one component can be coupled or connected directly to another component, and an intervening component can also be present between the components. When one component is described as being “coupled directly to” or “connected directly to” another component, it should be understood that no intervening component is present between the components.

(21) The terms used herein is used for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to limit the present disclosure. Singular expressions include plural expressions unless clearly described as different meanings in the context.

(22) The terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” “including,” “containing,” “has,” “having” or other variations thereof are inclusive and therefore specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof.

(23) Unless otherwise defined, all terms used herein, including technical or scientific terms, may have the same meaning as commonly understood by those skilled in the art to which the present disclosure pertains. The terms such as those defined in a commonly used dictionary may be interpreted as having meanings consistent with meanings in the context of related technologies and may not be interpreted as ideal or excessively formal meanings unless explicitly defined in the present application.

(24) Further, the following embodiments are provided to more completely explain the present disclosure to those skilled in the art, and shapes and sizes of elements illustrated in the drawings may be exaggerated for a more apparent description.

(25) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a robot cleaner 1 according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. 2 is a view illustrating some components separated from the robot cleaner 1 illustrated in FIG. 1, FIG. 3 is a rear view illustrating the robot cleaner 1 illustrated in FIG. 1,

FIG. 4 is a view illustrating some components separated from the robot cleaner **1** illustrated in FIG. 3, FIG. 5 is a bottom plan view illustrating the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. 6 is an exploded perspective view illustrating the robot cleaner **1**.

(26) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure is configured to be placed on a floor and clean the floor while moving on a floor surface B. Therefore, hereinafter, a vertical direction is defined based on a state in which the robot cleaner **1** is placed on the floor.

(27) Further, a side at which first and second support wheels **120** and **130** to be described below are coupled is defined as a front side based on a first rotary plate **10** and a second rotary plate **20**.

(28) Among the portions described in the embodiment of the present disclosure, a 'lowermost portion' may be a portion positioned at a lowest position or a portion closest to the floor when the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure is placed on the floor and used.

(29) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure includes a body **100**, a first rotary plate **10**, a second rotary plate **20**, a first mop **30**, and a second mop **40**.

(30) The body **100** may define an entire external shape of the robot cleaner **1** or may be provided in the form of a frame. Components constituting the robot cleaner **1** may be coupled to the body **100**, and some of the components constituting the robot cleaner **1** may be accommodated in the body **100**. The body **100** may be divided into a lower body **100a** and an upper body **100b**. The components of the robot cleaner **1** may be provided in a space defined by coupling the lower body **100a** and the upper body **100b** (see FIG. 6).

(31) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, a width (or a diameter) in a horizontal direction (i.e., a direction parallel to an X-axis and a Y-axis) of the body **100** may be larger than a height in a vertical direction (i.e., a direction parallel to a Z-axis) of the body **100**. The body **100** may provide an advantageous structure that assists the robot cleaner **1** in having a stable structure and allows the robot cleaner **1** to avoid an obstacle while moving traveling.

(32) The body **100** may have various shapes such as a circular shape, an elliptical shape, or a quadrangular shape when viewed from above or below.

(33) The first rotary plate **10** has a predetermined area and is provided in the form of a flat plate, a flat frame, or the like. The first rotary plate **10** is laid approximately horizontally, such that a width (or a diameter) in the horizontal direction is sufficiently larger than a height in the vertical direction thereof. The first rotary plate **10** coupled to the body **100** may be parallel to the floor surface B or inclined with respect to the floor surface B.

(34) The first rotary plate **10** may be provided in the form of a circular plate, a bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10** may be approximately circular.

(35) The first rotary plate **10** may entirely have a rotationally symmetrical shape.

(36) The first rotary plate **10** may include a first central plate **11**, a first outer peripheral plate **12**, and first spokes **13**.

(37) The first central plate **11** defines a center of the first rotary plate **10** and is rotatably coupled to the body **100**. The first central plate **11** may be coupled to the lower portion of the body **100**. The first central plate **11** may be coupled to the body **100** in such a way that an upper surface of the first central plate **11** is directed toward the bottom surface of the body **100**.

(38) A rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10** may be provided in a direction that penetrates the center of the first central plate **11**. In addition, the rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10** may be provided in a direction orthogonal to the floor surface B or inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the direction orthogonal to the floor surface B.

(39) The first outer peripheral plate **12** is spaced apart from the first central plate **11** and disposed to surround the first central plate **11**.

(40) The first spokes **13** connect the first central plate **11** and the first outer peripheral plate **12**. The first spokes **13** are provided in plural and repeatedly disposed in a circumferential direction of the first central plate **11**. The first spokes **13** may be arranged at an equal interval. A plurality of holes

14 penetratively formed in the vertical direction is provided between the first spokes **13**, and a liquid (e.g., water) discharged from a water supply tube **240** to be described below may be delivered to the first mop **30** through the holes **14**.

(41) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10** coupled to the body **100** may be inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the floor surface B. In this case, the rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10** may be inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the direction perpendicular to the floor surface B.

(42) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, an angle $\theta 1$ defined between the bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10** and the floor surface B may be equal to an angle $\theta 2$ defined between the rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10** and the direction perpendicular to the floor surface B. Therefore, the bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10** may maintain the same angle with respect to the floor surface B when the first rotary plate **10** rotates relative to the body **100**.

(43) The second rotary plate **20** has a predetermined area and is provided in the form of a flat plate, a flat frame, or the like. The second rotary plate **20** is laid approximately horizontally, such that a width (or a diameter) in the horizontal direction is sufficiently larger than a height in the vertical direction thereof. The second rotary plate **20** coupled to the body **100** may be parallel to the floor surface B or inclined with respect to the floor surface B.

(44) The second rotary plate **20** may be provided in the form of a circular plate, a bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20** may be approximately circular.

(45) The second rotary plate **20** may entirely have a rotationally symmetrical shape.

(46) The second rotary plate **20** may include a second central plate **21**, a second outer peripheral plate **22**, and second spokes **23**.

(47) The second central plate **21** defines a center of the second rotary plate **20** and is rotatably coupled to the body **100**. The second central plate **21** may be coupled to the lower portion of the body **100**. The second central plate **21** may be coupled to the body **100** in such a way that an upper surface of the second central plate **21** is directed toward the bottom surface of the body **100**.

(48) A rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20** may be provided in a direction that penetrates the center of the second central plate **21**. In addition, the rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20** may be provided in a direction orthogonal to the floor surface B or inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the direction orthogonal to the floor surface B.

(49) The second outer peripheral plate **22** is spaced apart from the second central plate **21** and disposed to surround the second central plate **21**.

(50) The second spokes **23** connect the second central plate **21** and the second outer peripheral plate **22**. The second spokes **23** are provided in plural and repeatedly disposed in a circumferential direction of the second central plate **21**. The second spokes **23** may be arranged at an equal interval. A plurality of holes **24** penetratively formed in the vertical direction is provided between the second spokes **23**, and a liquid (e.g., water) discharged from the water supply tube **240** to be described below may be delivered to the second mop **40** through the holes **24**.

(51) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20** coupled to the body **100** may be inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the floor surface B. In this case, the rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20** may be inclined at a predetermined angle with respect to the direction perpendicular to the floor surface B.

(52) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, an angle $\theta 3$ defined between the bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20** and the floor surface B may be equal to an angle $\theta 4$ defined between the rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20** and the direction perpendicular to the floor surface B. Therefore, the bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20** may maintain the same angle with respect to the floor surface B when the second rotary

plate **20** rotates relative to the body **100**.

(53) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the second rotary plate **20** may be identical to the first rotary plate **10** or the second rotary plate **20** and the first rotary plate **10** may be provided symmetrically. When the first rotary plate **10** is positioned at a left side of the robot cleaner **1**, the second rotary plate **20** may be positioned at a right side of the robot cleaner **1**. In this case, the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be vertically symmetric.

(54) A bottom surface of the first mop **30**, which is directed toward the floor, has a predetermined area, and the first mop **30** has a flat shape. The first mop **30** is configured such that a width (or a diameter) in the horizontal direction thereof is sufficiently larger than a height in the vertical direction thereof. When the first mop **30** is coupled to the body **100**, the bottom surface of the first mop **30** may be parallel to the floor surface B or inclined with respect to the floor surface B.

(55) The bottom surface of the first mop **30** may be approximately circular.

(56) The first mop **30** may entirely have a rotationally symmetrical shape.

(57) The first mop **30** may be made of various materials capable of wiping the floor while being in contact with the floor. To this end, the bottom surface of the first mop **30** may have a woven fabric, a knitted fabric, a non-woven fabric, and/or a brush having a predetermined area.

(58) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first mop **30** is attached to or detached from the bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10**. The first mop **30** is coupled to the first rotary plate **10** and rotates together with the first rotary plate **10**. The first mop **30** may be coupled to and in close contact with a bottom surface of the first outer peripheral plate **12** or coupled to and in close contact with a bottom surface of the first central plate **11** and the bottom surface of the first outer peripheral plate **12**.

(59) The first mop **30** may be attached to or detached from the first rotary plate **10** by various devices and various methods. As an embodiment, at least a part of the first mop **30** may be coupled to the first rotary plate **10** by being caught by or fitted with the first rotary plate **10**. As another embodiment, a separate device such as a clamp may be provided to couple the first mop **30** and the first rotary plate **10**. As still another embodiment, a pair of fastening devices (specific examples of the fastening devices include a pair of magnets configured to apply attractive forces to each other, a pair of Velcro fasteners configured to be coupled to each other, a pair of buttons (a female button and a male button) configured to be coupled to each other, or the like), which is configured to be coupled to or separated from each other, may be provided. One fastening device may be fixed to the first mop **30**, and the other fastening device may be fixed to the first rotary plate **10**.

(60) When the first mop **30** is coupled to the first rotary plate **10**, the first mop **30** and the first rotary plate **10** may be coupled to each other so as to overlap each other. Alternatively, the first mop **30** and the first rotary plate **10** may be coupled to each other in such a way that a center of the first mop **30** is coincident with a center of the first rotary plate **10**.

(61) A bottom surface of the second mop **40**, which is directed toward the floor, has a predetermined area, and the second mop **40** has a flat shape. The second mop **40** is configured such that a width (or a diameter) in the horizontal direction thereof is sufficiently larger than a height in the vertical direction thereof. When the second mop **40** is coupled to the body **100**, the bottom surface of the second mop **40** may be parallel to the floor surface B or inclined with respect to the floor surface B.

(62) The bottom surface of the second mop **40** may be approximately circular.

(63) The second mop **40** may entirely have a rotationally symmetrical shape.

(64) The second mop **40** may be made of various materials capable of wiping the floor while being in contact with the floor. To this end, the bottom surface of the second mop **40** may have a woven fabric, a knitted fabric, a non-woven fabric, and/or a brush having a predetermined area.

(65) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the second mop **40** is attached to or detached from the bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20**. The second mop **40** is coupled to the second rotary plate **20** and rotates together with the second rotary plate

20. The second mop **40** may be coupled to and in close contact with a bottom surface of the second outer peripheral plate **22** or coupled to and in close contact with a bottom surface of the second central plate **21** and the bottom surface of the second outer peripheral plate **22**.

(66) The second mop **40** may be attached to or detached from the second rotary plate **20** by various devices and various methods. As an embodiment, at least a part of the second mop **40** may be coupled to the second rotary plate **20** by being caught by or fitted with the second rotary plate **20**. As another embodiment, a separate device such as a clamp may be provided to couple the second mop **40** and the second rotary plate **20**. As still another embodiment, a pair of fastening devices (specific examples of the fastening devices include a pair of magnets configured to apply attractive forces to each other, a pair of Velcro fasteners configured to be coupled to each other, a pair of buttons (a female button and a male button) configured to be coupled to each other, or the like), which is configured to be coupled to or separated from each other, may be provided. One fastening device may be fixed to the second mop **40**, and the other fastening device may be fixed to the second rotary plate **20**.

(67) When the second mop **40** is coupled to the second rotary plate **20**, the second mop **40** and the second rotary plate **20** may be coupled to each other so as to overlap each other. Alternatively, the second mop **40** and the second rotary plate **20** may be coupled to each other in such a way that a center of the second mop **40** is coincident with a center of the second rotary plate **20**.

(68) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may rectilinearly move along the floor surface B. For example, the robot cleaner **1** may rectilinearly move forward (in the X-axis direction) while performing the cleaning operation and may rectilinearly move rearward to avoid an obstacle or a cliff.

(69) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be inclined with respect to the floor surface B so that portions of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20**, which are close to each other, are further spaced apart from the floor surface B than portions of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20**, which are distant from each other. That is, the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** are configured such that portions of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20**, which are distant from the center of the robot cleaner **1**, are closer to the floor than portions of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20**, which are close to the center of the robot cleaner **1** (see FIGS. 3 and 4).

(70) In addition, the first rotary plate **10** may be coupled to the rotary shaft **15** together with a first coupler **50** disposed above the first rotary plate **10**, and the second rotary plate **20** may be coupled to the rotary shaft **25** together with a second coupler **60** disposed above the second rotary plate **20**. Specific structures and shapes of the first and second couplers **50** and **60** will be described below in detail with reference to FIG. 8 and the following drawings.

(71) In this case, the rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10** may be disposed to be perpendicular to the bottom surface of the first rotary plate **10**, and the rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20** may be perpendicular to the bottom surface of the second rotary plate **20**.

(72) When the first mop **30** is coupled to the first rotary plate **10** and the second mop **40** is coupled to the second rotary plate **20**, the portions of the first and second mops **30** and **40**, which are distant from each other, are more strongly in contact with the floor.

(73) The frictional force is generated between the floor surface B and the bottom surface of the first mop **30** when the first rotary plate **10** rotates. In this case, a point at which the frictional force is generated and a direction in which the frictional force is generated deviate from the rotary shaft **15** of the first rotary plate **10**, such that the first rotary plate **10** moves relative to the floor surface B. Further, the robot cleaner **1** may move along the floor surface B.

(74) In addition, the frictional force is generated between the floor surface B and the bottom surface of the second mop **40** when the second rotary plate **20** rotates. In this case, a point at which the frictional force is generated and a direction in which the frictional force is generated deviate from the rotary shaft **25** of the second rotary plate **20**, such that the second rotary plate **20** moves

relative to the floor surface B. Further, the robot cleaner **1** may move along the floor surface B.

(75) When the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** rotate in opposite directions at the same velocity, the robot cleaner **1** may move forward or rearward in a straight direction. For example, when the first rotary plate **10** rotates counterclockwise and the second rotary plate **20** rotates clockwise when viewed from above, the robot cleaner **1** may move forward.

(76) When only any one of the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** rotates, the robot cleaner **1** may change the direction thereof and turn.

(77) When a rotational velocity of the first rotary plate **10** and a rotational velocity of the second rotary plate **20** are different from each other or the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** rotate in the same direction, the robot cleaner **1** may move while changing the direction thereof and move in a curved direction.

(78) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure includes a first support wheel **120**, a second support wheel **130**, and a first lower sensor **250**.

(79) The first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be configured to be in contact with the floor together with the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**.

(80) The first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** are spaced apart from each other and may each be provided in the form of a typical wheel. The first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be in contact with the floor and move while rolling. Therefore, the robot cleaner **1** may move along the floor surface B.

(81) The first support wheel **120** may be coupled to the bottom surface of the body **100** at a point at which the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** are spaced apart from each other. The second support wheel **130** may also be coupled to the bottom surface of the body **100** at the point at which the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** are spaced apart from each other.

(82) When an imaginary line connecting the center of the first rotary plate **10** and the center of the second rotary plate **20** in the horizontal direction (the direction parallel to the floor surface B) is defined as a connection line L1, the second support wheel **130** and the first support wheel **120** are positioned at the same side based on the connection line L1. In this case, an auxiliary wheel **140** to be described below and the first support wheel **120** are positioned at different sides based on the connection line L1.

(83) An interval between the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be comparatively large in consideration of an overall size of the robot cleaner **1**. More specifically, the interval between the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be set to the extent that the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may support a part of a load of the robot cleaner **1** and the robot cleaner **1** stands without falling down laterally in a state in which the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** are placed on the floor surface B (a state in which a rotation axis **125** of the first support wheel **120** and a rotation axis **135** of the second support wheel **130** are parallel to the floor surface B).

(84) The first support wheel **120** may be positioned in front of the first rotary plate **10**, and the second support wheel **130** may be positioned in front of the second rotary plate **20**.

(85) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, an overall center **105** of gravity may be disposed closer to the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** than are the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**. The first mop **30** and the second mop **40** support a greater proportion of the load of the robot cleaner **1** than the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**.

(86) The first lower sensor **250** is provided at the lower side of the body **100** and configured to detect a relative distance to the floor B. The first lower sensor **250** may be variously configured as long as the first lower sensor **250** may detect the relative distance between the floor surface B and the point at which the first lower sensor **250** is provided.

(87) When the relative distance to the floor surface B (a distance in the vertical direction from the floor surface or a distance in the direction inclined with respect to the floor surface), which is

detected by the first lower sensor **250**, exceeds a predetermined value or exceeds a predetermined range, this may be a case in which the floor surface is rapidly lowered. Therefore, the first lower sensor **250** may detect a cliff.

(88) The first lower sensor **250** may be an optical sensor and include a light-emitting portion for emitting light, and a light-receiving portion for receiving reflected light. The first lower sensor **250** may be an infrared sensor.

(89) The first lower sensor **250** may be referred to as a cliff sensor.

(90) The first lower sensor **250**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** are provided at the same side based on the connection line **L1**.

(91) The first lower sensor **250** is positioned between the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** in a peripheral direction of the body **100**. In the robot cleaner **1**, when the first support wheel **120** is positioned at a relatively left side and the second support wheel **130** is positioned at a relatively right side, the first lower sensor **250** is positioned at an approximately intermediate portion.

(92) The first lower sensor **250** is provided forward from the support wheels **120** and **130**.

(93) When the first lower sensor **250** is provided on the lower surface of the body **100**, the first lower sensor **250** may be provided at a point sufficiently spaced apart from the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** (and a point sufficiently spaced apart from the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**) to allow the first lower sensor **250** to quickly detect a cliff positioned in front of the robot cleaner **1** and to prevent the detection of cliff by the first lower sensor **250** from being hindered by the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**. Therefore, the first lower sensor **250** is provided adjacent to a rim of the body **100**.

(94) The operation of the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may be controlled based on the distance detected by the first lower sensor **250**. More specifically, the rotation of any one of the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be controlled based on the distance detected by the first lower sensor **250**. For example, when the distance detected by the first lower sensor **250** exceeds a predetermined value or a predetermined range, the rotations of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20** are stopped such that the robot cleaner **1** may be stopped, or the rotation directions of the first rotary plate **10** and/or the second rotary plate **20** are changed such that the movement direction of the robot cleaner **1** may be changed.

(95) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, a detection direction of the first lower sensor **250** may be inclined downward toward the rim of the body **100**. For example, in the case in which the first lower sensor **250** is an optical sensor, a direction of the light emitted from the first lower sensor **250** may not be perpendicular to the floor surface **B** but inclined forward.

(96) Therefore, the first lower sensor **250** may detect a cliff positioned in front of the first lower sensor **250** and detect a cliff positioned comparatively in front of the body **100**, thereby preventing the robot cleaner **1** from reaching the cliff.

(97) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may change the direction thereof to the left or right and move in the curved direction while performing the cleaning operation. In this case, the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** are in contact with the floor and support the load of the robot cleaner **1**.

(98) When the robot cleaner **1** moves while changing the direction thereof to the left, the first lower sensor **250** may detect a cliff **F** before the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** reach the cliff **F**, and the first lower sensor **250** may detect the cliff **F** before the second support wheel **130** at least reaches the cliff **F**. The load of the robot cleaner **1** is supported by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** or supported at least by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, and the second support wheel **130** while the first lower sensor **250** detects the cliff **F**.

(99) When the robot cleaner **1** moves while rotating to the right, the first lower sensor **250** may detect the cliff **F** before the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** reach the

cliff F, and the first lower sensor **250** may detect the cliff F before the first support wheel **120** at least reaches the cliff F. The load of the robot cleaner **1** is supported by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** or supported at least by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, and the first support wheel **120** while the first lower sensor **250** detects the cliff F.

(100) As described above, according to the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first lower sensor may detect the cliff F before the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** reach the cliff F not only when the robot cleaner **1** rectilinearly moves but also when the robot cleaner **1** changes the direction thereof. Therefore, it is possible to prevent the robot cleaner **1** from falling from the cliff F and prevent the robot cleaner **1** from losing the overall balance.

(101) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure includes a second lower sensor **260** and a third lower sensor **270**.

(102) The second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** are disposed at the same side as the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** based on the connection line L1 and provided at the lower side of the body **100**. The second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** are configured to detect relative distances to the floor B.

(103) When the second lower sensor **260** is provided on the lower surface of the body **100**, the second lower sensor **260** is spaced apart from the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** to prevent the detection of the cliff F by the second lower sensor **260** from being hindered by the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**. In addition, the second lower sensor **260** may be provided at a point spaced apart outward from the first support wheel **120** or the second support wheel **130** in order to quickly detect the cliff F positioned at the left side or the right side of the robot cleaner **1**. The second lower sensor **260** may be provided adjacent to the rim of the body **100**.

(104) The second lower sensor **260** may be provided at the opposite side to the first lower sensor **250** based on the first support wheel **120**. Therefore, the cliff F positioned at one side of the first support wheel **120** may be detected by the first lower sensor **250**, and the cliff F positioned at the other side of the first support wheel **120** may be detected by the second lower sensor **260**, such that the cliff F positioned at the periphery of the first support wheel **120** may be effectively detected.

(105) When the third lower sensor **270** is provided on the lower surface of the body **100**, the third lower sensor **270** is spaced apart from the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** to prevent the detection of the cliff F by the third lower sensor **270** from being hindered by the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**. In addition, the third lower sensor **270** may be provided at a point spaced apart outward from the first support wheel **120** or the second support wheel **130** in order to quickly detect the cliff F positioned at the left side or the right side of the robot cleaner **1**. The third lower sensor **260** may be provided adjacent to the rim of the body **100**.

(106) The third lower sensor **270** may be provided at the opposite side to the first lower sensor **250** based on the second support wheel **130**. Therefore, the cliff F positioned at one side of the second support wheel **130** may be detected by the first lower sensor **250**, and the cliff F positioned at the other side of the second support wheel **130** may be detected by the third lower sensor **270**, such that the cliff F positioned at the periphery of the second support wheel **130** may be effectively detected.

(107) The second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** may be variously configured as long as the second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** may each detect the relative distance to the floor surface B. The second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** may be identical to the first lower sensor **250** except for the positions at which the sensors are provided.

(108) The operation of the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may be controlled based on the distance detected by the second lower sensor **260**. More specifically, the rotation of any one of the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be controlled based on the distance detected by the second lower sensor **260**. For example, when the distance detected by the second lower sensor **260** exceeds a predetermined value or a

predetermined range, the rotations of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20** are stopped such that the robot cleaner **1** may be stopped, or the rotation directions of the first rotary plate **10** and/or the second rotary plate **20** are changed such that the movement direction of the robot cleaner **1** may be changed.

(109) In addition, the operation of the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may be controlled based on the distance detected by the third lower sensor **270**. More specifically, the rotation of any one of the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be controlled based on the distance detected by the third lower sensor **270**. For example, when the distance detected by the third lower sensor **270** exceeds a predetermined value or a predetermined range, the rotations of the first and second rotary plates **10** and **20** are stopped such that the robot cleaner **1** may be stopped, or the rotation directions of the first rotary plate **10** and/or the second rotary plate **20** are changed such that the movement direction of the robot cleaner **1** may be changed.

(110) A distance from the connection line L1 to the second lower sensor **260** and a distance from the connection line L1 to the third lower sensor **270** may be shorter than a distance from the connection line L1 to the first support wheel **120** and a distance from the connection line L1 to the second support wheel **130**.

(111) In addition, the second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** are positioned outside a vertical region of a quadrangle having vertices defined by a center of the first rotary plate **10**, a center of the second rotary plate **20**, a center of the first support wheel **120**, and a center of the second support wheel **130**.

(112) When the second lower sensor **260** is positioned at the left side of the robot cleaner **1**, the third lower sensor **270** may be positioned at the right side of the robot cleaner **1**.

(113) The second lower sensor **260** and the third lower sensor **270** may be symmetric to each other.

(114) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may turn. In this case, the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** are in contact with the floor and support the load of the robot cleaner **1**.

(115) When the cliff F is positioned at the left side of the robot cleaner **1** and the robot cleaner **1** turns or changes the direction thereof to the left, the second lower sensor **260** may detect the cliff F before the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** reach the cliff F. The load of the robot cleaner **1** is supported by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** while the second lower sensor **260** detects the cliff F.

(116) In addition, when the cliff F is positioned at the right side of the robot cleaner **1** and the robot cleaner **1** turns or changes the direction thereof to the right, the third lower sensor **270** may detect the cliff F before the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** reach the cliff F. The load of the robot cleaner **1** is supported by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130** while the third lower sensor **270** detects the cliff F.

(117) As described above, according to the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, it is possible to prevent the robot cleaner **1** from falling from the cliff F and prevent the robot cleaner **1** from losing the overall balance when the robot cleaner **1** changes the direction thereof or rotates to one side.

(118) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may include the auxiliary wheel **140** together with the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**.

(119) The auxiliary wheel **140** may be coupled to the lower portion of the body **100** and spaced apart from the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20**.

(120) The auxiliary wheel **140** is positioned at a different side from the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** based on the connection line L1.

(121) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, the auxiliary wheel **140** may be provided in the form of a typical wheel, and a rotation axis **145** of the auxiliary wheel **140** may be parallel to the

floor surface B. The auxiliary wheel **140** may be in contact with the floor and move while rolling. Therefore, the robot cleaner may move along the floor surface B.

(122) However, in the embodiment of the present disclosure, the auxiliary wheel **140** is not in contact with the floor when the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** are in contact with the floor.

(123) Based on the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20**, the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** are positioned at the front side, and the auxiliary wheel **140** is positioned at the rear side.

(124) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20** may be symmetric (vertically symmetric) to each other, and the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be symmetric (vertically symmetric) to each other.

(125) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, in the state in which the first mop **30** is coupled to the first rotary plate **10** and the second mop **40** is coupled to the second rotary plate **20**, the first support wheel **120**, the second support wheel **130**, and the auxiliary wheel **140** do not hinder the contact between the floor and the first and second mops **30** and **40**.

(126) Therefore, the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** are in contact with the floor, such that the mopping and cleaning operation may be performed by the rotations of the first and second mops **30** and **40**. In this case, all the first support wheel **120**, the second support wheel **130**, and the auxiliary wheel **140** may be spaced apart from the floor. Alternately, the auxiliary wheel **140** may be spaced apart from the floor, and the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be in contact with the floor.

(127) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, in the state in which the robot cleaner **1** is placed on the floor so that the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** are in contact with the floor, a height from the floor surface B to the lowest portion of the first support wheel **120** and a height from the floor surface B to the lowest portion of the second support wheel **130** may be smaller than a height from the floor surface B to the lowest portion of the auxiliary wheel **140**.

(128) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure includes a first actuator **160**, a second actuator **170**, the battery **220**, the water container **230**, and the water supply tube **240**.

(129) The first actuator **160** is coupled to the body **100** and configured to rotate the first rotary plate **10**.

(130) The first actuator **160** may include a first casing **161**, a first motor **162**, and one or more first gears **163**.

(131) The first casing **161** is fixedly coupled to the body **100** and supports components constituting the first actuator **160**.

(132) The first motor **162** may be an electric motor.

(133) The plurality of first gears **163** meshes with each other and rotates together. The plurality of first gears **163** connects the first motor **162** and the first rotary plate **10** and transmits rotational power from the first motor **162** to the first rotary plate **10**. Therefore, the first rotary plate **10** rotates when a rotary shaft of the first motor **162** rotates.

(134) The second actuator **170** is coupled to the body **100** and configured to rotate the second rotary plate **20**.

(135) The second actuator **170** may include a second casing **171**, a second motor **172**, and one or more second gears **173**.

(136) The second casing **171** is fixedly coupled to the body **100** and supports components constituting the second actuator **170**.

(137) The second motor **172** may be an electric motor.

(138) The plurality of second gears **173** meshes with each other and rotates together. The plurality of second gears **173** connects the second motor **172** and the second rotary plate **20** and transmits

rotational power from the second motor **172** to the second rotary plate **20**. Therefore, the second rotary plate **20** rotates when a rotary shaft of the second motor **172** rotates.

(139) As described above, in the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first rotary plate **10** and the first mop **30** may be rotated by the operation of the first actuator **160**, and the second rotary plate **20** and the second mop **40** may be rotated by the operation of the second actuator **170**.

(140) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first actuator **160** may be disposed directly on the first rotary plate **10**. This configuration may minimize a loss of power transmitted from the first actuator **160** to the first rotary plate **10**. In addition, a load of the first actuator **160** may be applied to the first rotary plate **10**, such that the first mop **30** may perform the mopping operation while generating sufficient friction with the floor.

(141) In addition, in the embodiment of the present disclosure, the second actuator **170** may be disposed directly on the second rotary plate **20**. This configuration may minimize a loss of power transmitted from the second actuator **170** to the second rotary plate **20**. In addition, a load of the second actuator **170** may be applied to the second rotary plate **20**, such that the second mop **40** may perform the mopping operation while generating sufficient friction with the floor.

(142) The second actuator **170** and the first actuator **160** may be symmetric (vertically symmetric).

(143) The battery **220** is coupled to the body **100** and configured to supply power to the other components constituting the robot cleaner **1**. The battery **220** may supply power to the first actuator **160** and the second actuator **170**. In particular, the battery **220** supplies power to the first motor **162** and the second motor **172**.

(144) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, the battery **220** may be charged with external power. To this end, a charging terminal for charging the battery **220** may be provided at one side of the body **100** or provided on the battery **220**.

(145) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the battery **220** may be coupled to the body **100**.

(146) The water container **230** is provided in the form of a container having an internal space that stores therein a liquid such as water. The water container **230** may be fixedly coupled to the body **100** or detachably coupled to the body **100**.

(147) In the embodiment of the present disclosure, the water container **230** may be positioned above the auxiliary wheel **140**.

(148) The water supply tube **240** is provided in the form of a tube or a pipe and connected to the water container **230** so that the liquid in the water container **230** may flow through the inside of the water supply tube **240**. An end of the water supply tube **240**, which is opposite to the side at which the water supply tube **240** is connected to the water container **230**, is provided above the first rotary plate **10** and the second rotary plate **20**, such that the liquid in the water container **230** may be supplied to the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**.

(149) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the water supply tube **240** may be provided in a shape having two tube portions diverged from a single tube portion. In this case, an end of one diverged tube portion may be positioned above the first rotary plate **10**, and an end of the other diverged tube portion may be positioned above the second rotary plate **20**.

(150) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, a separate pump may be provided to move the liquid through the water supply tube **240**.

(151) The center **105** of gravity of the robot cleaner **1** may be positioned in the vertical region of the quadrangle having the vertices defined by the center of the first rotary plate **10**, the center of the second rotary plate **20**, the center of the first support wheel **120**, and the center of the second support wheel **130**. Therefore, the robot cleaner **1** is supported by the first mop **30**, the second mop **40**, the first support wheel **120**, and the second support wheel **130**.

(152) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first

actuator **160**, the second actuator **170**, the battery **220**, and the water container **230** may each serve as a comparatively heavyweight member in the robot cleaner **1**. Therefore, the overall center **105** of gravity of the robot cleaner **1** may be positioned at the central portion of the robot cleaner **1** as the first actuator **160** and the second actuator **170** are positioned on or adjacent to the connection line, the battery **220** is positioned at the front side of the connection line, and the water container **230** is positioned at the rear side of the connection line. Therefore, the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** may be in stable contact with the floor.

(153) In addition, since the first actuator **160**, the second actuator **170**, the battery **220**, and the water container **230** are positioned in different regions, respectively, in a top plan view, the weight distribution may be stably performed, such that the body **100** and the robot cleaner **1** may become comparatively flat. Therefore, the robot cleaner **1** may be configured to easily enter a lower space of a shelf, a table, or the like.

(154) In addition, according to the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the weight distribution may be performed in such a way that only the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** are in contact with the floor and clean the floor when the robot cleaner **1** initially operates with the water container **230** sufficiently filled with the liquid. When the center of gravity of the robot cleaner **1** is moved forward as the liquid in the water container **230** is used, the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**, together with the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**, may be in contact with the floor and clean the floor.

(155) In addition, according to the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**, together with the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**, may be in contact with the floor and clean the floor regardless of whether the liquid in the water container **230** is used.

(156) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may be configured such that the second lower sensor **260**, the first support wheel **120**, the first lower sensor **250**, the second support wheel **130**, and the third lower sensor **270** are arranged in this order in the peripheral direction of the body **100**.

(157) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating the robot cleaner **1** and components of the robot cleaner **1** according to still another embodiment of the present disclosure.

(158) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may include a control part **180**, a bumper **190**, a first sensor **200**, and a second sensor **210**.

(159) The control part **180** may be configured to control the operations of the first and second actuators **160** and **170** based on preset information or real-time information. The robot cleaner **1** may be provided with a storage medium that stores an application program for the control operation of the control part **180**. The control part **180** may be configured to control the robot cleaner **1** by executing the application program based on information inputted to the robot cleaner **1** and information outputted from the robot cleaner **1**.

(160) The bumper **190** is coupled along the rim of the body **100** and configured to move relative to the body **100**. For example, the bumper **190** may be coupled to the body **100** so as to be reciprocally movable in a direction toward the center of the body **100**.

(161) The bumper **190** may be coupled along a part of the rim of the body **100** or coupled along the entire rim of the body **100**.

(162) In the robot cleaner according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the lowest portion of the body **100**, which is disposed at the same side as the bumper **190** based on the connection line **L1**, may be equal to or higher in height than the lowest portion of the bumper **190**. That is, the bumper **190** may be equal to or lower in height than the body **100**. Therefore, an obstacle positioned at a comparatively low position may collide with the bumper **190**, and the bumper **190** may detect the obstacle.

(163) The first sensor **200** may be coupled to the body **100** and configured to detect a motion (relative movement) of the bumper **190** relative to the body **100**. The first sensor **200** may be a

microswitch, a photo-interrupter, a tact switch, or the like.

(164) When the bumper **190** of the robot cleaner **1** comes into contact with an obstacle, the control part **180** may control the robot cleaner **1** to allow the robot cleaner **1** to avoid the obstacle. The control part **180** may control the operation of the first actuator **160** and/or the second actuator **170** based on information detected by the first sensor **200**. For example, when the bumper **190** comes into contact with an obstacle while the robot cleaner **1** moves, the first sensor **120** may recognize a position at which the bumper **190** comes into contact with the obstacle, and the control part **180** may control the operations of the first actuator **160** and/or the second actuator **170** so that the robot cleaner **1** departs from the contact position.

(165) The second sensor **210** may be coupled to the body **100** and configured to detect a relative distance to an obstacle. The second sensor **210** may be a distance sensor.

(166) When a distance between the robot cleaner **1** and the obstacle is a predetermined value or less based on information detected by the second sensor **210**, the control part **180** may control the operations of the first actuator **160** and/or the second actuator **170** so that the movement direction of the robot cleaner **1** is changed or the robot cleaner **1** moves away from the obstacle.

(167) In addition, based on a distance detected by the first lower sensor **250**, the second lower sensor **260**, or the third lower sensor **270**, the control part **180** may control the operations of the first actuator **160** and/or the second actuator **170** so that the robot cleaner **1** is stopped or the movement direction is changed.

(168) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may move (travel) by means of a frictional force generated between the first mop **30** and the floor surface B when the first rotary plate **10** rotates and a frictional force generated between the second mop **40** and the floor surface B when the second rotary plate **20** rotates.

(169) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be configured so as not to hinder the movement (traveling) of the robot cleaner **1** by the frictional force with the floor. Further, the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** may be configured so as not to increase a load when the robot cleaner **1** moves (travels).

(170) To this end, a width of the first support wheel **120** and a width of the second support wheel **130** may be sufficiently smaller than a diameter of the first rotary plate **10** or a diameter of the second rotary plate **20**.

(171) With the above-mentioned configuration, even though the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**, together with the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**, are in contact with the floor and the robot cleaner **1** operates, the frictional force between the first support wheel **120** and the floor surface B and the frictional force between the second support wheel **130** and the floor surface B are significantly lower than the frictional force between the first mop **30** and the floor surface B and the frictional force between the second mop **40** and the floor surface B. Therefore, an unnecessary loss of power does not occur, and the movement of the robot cleaner **1** is not hindered.

(172) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may be stably supported at four points by the first support wheel **120**, the second support wheel **130**, the first mop **30**, and the second mop **40**.

(173) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the rotation axis **125** of the first support wheel **120** and the rotation axis **135** of the second support wheel **130** may be parallel to the connection line L1. That is, the rotation axis **125** of the first support wheel **120** and the rotation axis **135** of the second support wheel **130** may be fixed (fixed in a left-right direction) in position on the body **100**.

(174) The first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130**, together with the first mop **30** and the second mop **40**, may be in contact with the floor. In this case, in order to rectilinearly move the robot cleaner **1**, the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** may rotate in opposite directions at the

same velocity, and the first support wheel **120** and the second support wheel **130** assist the forward and rearward rectilinear movements of the robot cleaner **1**.

(175) The robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure may include an auxiliary wheel body **150**. In this case, the auxiliary wheel body **150** is rotatably coupled to the lower portion of the body **100**, and the auxiliary wheel **140** is rotatably coupled to the auxiliary wheel body **150**.

(176) That is, the auxiliary wheel **140** is connected to the body **100** through the auxiliary wheel body **150**.

(177) Further, the rotation axis **145** of the auxiliary wheel **140** and the rotation axis **155** of the auxiliary wheel body **150** may intersect each other, and a direction of the rotation axis **145** of the auxiliary wheel **140** may be orthogonal to a direction of the rotation axis **155** of the auxiliary wheel body **150**. For example, a rotation axis **155** of the auxiliary wheel body **150** may extend in the vertical direction or may be slightly inclined with respect to the vertical direction. The rotation axis **145** of the auxiliary wheel **140** may extend in the horizontal direction.

(178) In the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the auxiliary wheel **140** is in contact with the floor surface B when the robot cleaner **1** is not substantially used (in a state in which the first mop **30** and the second mop **40** are separated from the robot cleaner **1**). When the robot cleaner **1** is intended to be moved in this state, a direction in which the auxiliary wheel **140** is directed is freely changed by the auxiliary wheel body **150**, such that the robot cleaner **1** may be easily moved.

(179) FIG. **8** is a perspective view illustrating a separated structure of a first coupler **50** included in the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. **9** is a cross-sectional view illustrating the first coupler **50** included in the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from one side, and FIG. **10** is a view illustrating the first coupler **50** included in the robot cleaner **1** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure when viewed from above.

(180) Referring to FIGS. **8** to **10**, the robot cleaner **1** according to the present disclosure may further include couplers **50** and **60**. Hereinafter, the first coupler **50** coupled to an upper portion of the first rotary plate **10** will be described in detail. Like the first coupler **50**, the second coupler **60** may be coupled to an upper portion of the second rotary plate **20**.

(181) Hereinafter, in the description of the shape of the first coupler **50**, the term “upper side” or “upper portion” means a direction of the lower body **100a**, and the term “lower side” or “lower portion” means a direction of the first mop **30**.

(182) The first coupler **50** is disposed on the upper portion of the first rotary plate **10**. In more detail, the first coupler **50** may be disposed on an upper portion of the first central plate **11** and coupled by being penetrated by the rotary shaft **15**. The first coupler **50** may include a first coupling portion **51** having an internal space corresponding to the shape of the rotary shaft **15** so that the first coupler **50** may be coupled by being penetrated by the rotary shaft **15**.

(183) The first coupling portion **51** may have a cylindrical shape. The first coupling portion **51** may have the internal space formed at a center thereof and having a length in a longitudinal direction that is longer than a length in a transverse direction. In addition, as another embodiment, when the shape of the rotary shaft **15** is changed, the shape of the internal space may be changed depending on the shape of the rotary shaft **15**. An outer surface of the first coupling portion **51** is formed to surround a ring portion having a predetermined thickness and protruding from a central portion of the first central plate **11**.

(184) The first coupler **50** may include first support portions **53** connected to the first coupling portion **51** and extending from an outer circumference of the first coupling portion **51** by a predetermined width.

(185) Referring to FIG. **8**, the first support portions **53** may be provided in the form of a plurality of plates radially extending from the outer circumferential surface of the first coupling portion **51**. As

the number of plates of the first support portions **53** increases, the outer peripheries of the first support portions **53** may become approximately circular. As the number of plates increases, the vacant spaces between the plates are narrowed, which increases the efficiency in dispersing the stress of the first central plate **11**.

(186) Referring to FIGS. **8** to **10**, the first support portion **53** may include a first support end **53a**, a second support end **53b**, a wrinkled portion **53c**, and a blade portion **53d**.

(187) In the first support portion **53**, the wrinkled portion **53c**, the second support end **53b**, and the blade portion **53d** may be sequentially connected to the first support end **53a** in the radial direction.

(188) The first support end **53a** may protrude and extend from the outer circumferential surface of the first coupling portion **51**. According to the embodiment in which the first support portions **53** are provided in the form of the plurality of plates, the first support end **53a** may have a ring-shaped flat plate, and quadrangular flat plates protruding from the outer circumferential surface and disposed at predetermined angles around the central axis.

(189) The second support end **53b** is connected to one end of the first support end **53a** with a level difference from the first support end **53a**. The first support end **53a** and the second support end **53b** may constitute a cantilevered beam and thus functions as a flat spring. This configuration will be described below in detail with reference to FIG. **15**.

(190) The wrinkled portion **53c** may be disposed between the first support end **53a** and the second support end **53b**. The wrinkled portion **53c** may have two or more stepped portions so that the second support end **53b** may move as a free end of the cantilevered beam.

(191) An inner end of the second support end **53b** is fixed, and an outer end of the second support end **53b** may be rotated by a predetermined angle by pressure applied from below. Therefore, the wrinkled portion **53c** may have a multi-step structure so that the second support end **53b** may move.

(192) The blade portion **53d** may be formed at an outer end of the second support end **53b**, i.e., an outermost side of the first coupler **50**. Referring to FIG. **9**, the blade portion **53d** may be formed to be inclined upward from the second support end **53b** to support a protruding projection of the central plate **11**.

(193) The blade portion **53d** may be made of metal. Because of the material property, the blade portion **53d** may provide an elastic force for mitigating stress to be transmitted to the central plate **11**. The blade portion **53d** may be deformed by the projection of the central plate **11** so that an angle of the blade portion **53d** with respect to the second support end **53b** becomes close to 90°. The blade portion **53d** made of metal may have a restoring force for returning the angle of the blade portion **53d** to the original angle.

(194) A predetermined angle between the blade portion **53d** and the second support end **53b** may be set within a range in which a sufficient restoring force may be provided to bring the blade portion **53d** into stable contact with the projection of the first central plate **11** and to mitigate the stress to be transmitted to the central plate **11**.

(195) The angle of the blade portion **53d** with respect to the second support end **53b** may be smaller than 90°. Referring to FIG. **3**, the stress directed toward the center of the first coupler **50** from the first central plate **11** is applied to a contact point at which the first rotary plate **10**, together with the first mop **30**, is in contact with the ground surface. Therefore, the stress is determined by torque ($T=F \times R$) generated by a distance R from the center of the first rotary plate **10** and a force F applied from the ground surface. Because the elastic force for mitigating the stress is more effective than a rotational elastic force directed toward the ground surface, the angle of the blade portion **53d** with respect to the second support end **53b** may be smaller than 90°.

(196) The first coupler **50** may further include a first close-contact portion **52** extending, by a predetermined length, toward a lower end thereof, i.e., toward the ground surface from an inner end that defines the internal space of the first coupling portion **51**. The first close-contact portion **52** may come into surface contact with an outer circumferential surface of the rotary shaft **15** and

prevent the rotary shaft **15** from swaying.

(197) Typically, there are many obstacles such as foreign substances or doorsills on the ground surface on which the robot cleaner **1** moves, and the robot cleaner **1** passes over the obstacles in accordance with the functional properties of the robot cleaner **1**. When the robot cleaner **1** passes over the obstacle, the irregular swaying of the body **100** may be transmitted to the rotary shaft **15**. The swaying applied to the rotary shaft **15** may act as stress that damages the first central plate **11** in contact with and coupled to the rotary shaft **15**. Therefore, the embodiment of the present disclosure includes the first close-contact portion **52** provided in the internal space coupled to the rotary shaft **15** of the first coupler **50**, thereby minimizing the swaying to be transmitted to the rotary shaft **15**.

(198) The first close-contact portion **52** may correspond to the shape of the rotary shaft **15**. The first close-contact portion **52** is disposed in the internal space of the first coupling portion **51**. Since the internal space of the first coupling portion **51** corresponds to the shape of the rotary shaft **15**, and the shape of the first close-contact portion **52** may correspond to the shape of the rotary shaft **15**. Therefore, when the rotary shaft **15** has a cylindrical shape, the first close-contact portion **52** may have a curved surface with a predetermined height to correspond to the shape of the rotary shaft **15**. When the rotary shaft **15** includes a flat surface, the first close-contact portion **52** may have a flat plate shape to correspond to the shape of the rotary shaft **15**. In addition, referring to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **10**, the first close-contact portion **52** may have a flat plate shape in a longitudinal direction and a curved surface in a transverse direction.

(199) Referring to FIG. **8**, the first close-contact portion **52** may include a plurality of flat springs extending downward. The first close-contact portion **52** may prevent the rotary shaft **15** and the first central plate **11** from coming into direct contact with each other. In addition, the first close-contact portion **52** may be made of metal having elasticity to reduce the swaying of the rotary shaft **15**, and thus the first close-contact portion **52** may function as a flat spring. Therefore, when the first close-contact portion **52** is deformed toward the first central plate **11** by the swaying of the rotary shaft **15**, the restoring force may be generated to return the first close-contact portion **52** to the original state. Therefore, the stress of the rotary shaft **15** may be offset by the restoring force of the first close-contact portion **52**, thereby preventing damage to the first central plate **11**.

(200) The plurality of flat springs of first close-contact portion **52** may be spaced apart from one another at predetermined intervals. The first close-contact portion **52** may be in close contact with the rotary shaft **15** in at least four directions to provide the restoring force correspond to the irregular swaying of the rotary shaft **15**. Therefore, the first close-contact portion **52** may include at least four flat springs. In addition, since the first close-contact portion **52** includes the plurality of flat springs, it is possible to prevent the damage even though the rotary shaft **15** strongly sways in one direction.

(201) In the case in which the first close-contact portion **52** includes the plurality of flat springs, the plurality of flat springs may be spaced apart from one another at predetermined intervals. The flat springs generate the restoring force for returning the rotary shaft to the original state when the flat springs move by a predetermined angle by the swaying of the rotary shaft **15**. Therefore, the flat springs may be disposed at predetermined intervals, such that the flat springs are prevented from coming into contact with one another, thereby preventing the movements of the flat springs from being hindered.

(202) FIG. **11** is an exploded perspective view illustrating a separated structure in which the first rotary plate **10** and the first coupler **50** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled, FIG. **12** is a view illustrating a structure in which the first rotary plate **10** and the first coupler **50** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled when viewed from above, and FIG. **13** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a structure in which the first rotary plate **10**, the first coupler **50**, and the first mop **30** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled when viewed from one side.

(203) Referring to FIG. 11, the first rotary plate **10** and the first coupler **50** may be coupled to each other. In the step of coupling the first rotary plate **10**, the first central plate **11**, the first spokes **13**, and the first outer peripheral plate **12** are coupled, and then the rotary shaft **15** may be penetratively coupled to the first coupler **50** with the first central plate **11** interposed therebetween. In more detail, the rotary shaft **15** may include a coupling pin **15a**, a shaft driving portion **15b**, and a shaft body **15c** (see FIG. 13), and the first central plate **11** may be fixedly coupled and disposed between the shaft body **15c** and the coupling pin **15a**.

(204) The first coupler **50** may be disposed on the upper portion of the first central plate **11** and fixedly coupled and disposed, together with the first central plate **11**, between the shaft body **15c** and the coupling pin **15a**. Therefore, according to the coupling sequence, after the first central plate **11**, the first spokes **13**, and the first outer peripheral plate **12** are coupled, the first central plate **11** is covered by the first coupler **50**, and then the rotary shaft **15** may be coupled while penetrating the first central plate **11** and the first coupler **50**.

(205) Referring to FIG. 12, the first coupler **50** may extend radially to correspond to the number of first spokes **13**. The stress, which is generated when the first rotary plate **10** comes into contact with the floor surface, may be transmitted in the direction toward the center from the portion where the first rotary plate **10** comes into contact with the floor surface (see FIG. 3). Therefore, the stress may be transmitted to the first central plate **11** from one side of the first outer peripheral plate **12** through any one of the first spokes **13**. In order to disperse the transmitted stress, the first coupler **50** extends to correspond to the first spokes **13**, and a direction of the first coupler **50** and a direction of the first spokes **13** are coincident with each other so as to be positioned on the same imaginary line, thereby improving the efficiency in receiving the stress.

(206) According to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 12, the first support portions **53** of the first coupler **50** may be provided in the form of a plurality of flat plates each having a width that decreases outward in the radial direction.

(207) The plurality of first spokes **13** are radially disposed along the outer circumferential surface of the first central plate **11**. The water may be delivered from the water container **230** to the first mop **30** disposed below the water container **230** through the holes **14** present between the first spokes **13**. Therefore, the plurality of first spokes **13** may have a minimum width to smoothly supply the water to the first mop **30**.

(208) An end of the first support portion **53**, which is close to the first spoke **13**, may have a width corresponding to a width of the first spoke **13** to improve the efficiency in receiving the stress. Further, in order to disperse the stress transmitted to the first central plate **11** from the rotary shaft **15**, the radial flat plates of the first support portions **53**, which are close to the rotary shaft **15**, may be connected to each other to define an approximately circular shape. Therefore, the first support portions **53** may be provided in the form of the plurality of flat plates each having a width that increases inward in the radial direction.

(209) Referring to FIG. 13, the rotary shaft **15b** may be disposed to be inclined at a predetermined angle $\theta_{sub.2}$ with respect to the direction perpendicular to the first mop **30**. As described above, the rotary shaft **15b** is disposed at a predetermined angle $\theta_{sub.2}$ with respect to the direction perpendicular to the ground surface to move forward and rearward. Therefore, the first central plate **11**, the first outer peripheral plate **12**, the first spokes **13**, and the first coupler **50**, which are coupled by the rotary shaft, may be disposed at the predetermined angle $\theta_{sub.2}$ with respect to the direction perpendicular to the ground surface.

(210) According to the embodiment of the present disclosure, the predetermined angle $\theta_{sub.2}$ of the first rotary plate **10** continuously generates the stress at the position at which the first rotary plate **10** comes into contact with the ground surface. The generated stress is transmitted in the direction toward the center of the first rotary plate **10** and causes damage. Therefore, the first coupler **50** may solve the above-mentioned problem by dispersing the stress.

(211) FIG. 14 is a partial cross-sectional view illustrating an enlarged part in which the first rotary

plate **10** and the first coupler **50** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled, and FIGS. **15A** and **15B** are partial cross-sectional views illustrating states before and after the first coupler **50** and the first rotary plate **10** according to the embodiment of the present disclosure are coupled.

(212) Referring to FIG. **14**, the blade portions **53d** of the first coupler **50** are in contact with and support the protruding projection of the first central plate **11**. The first central plate **11** has the central portion having the internal space to which the rotary shaft **15** may be coupled. The first central plate **11** may have a coupling portion having a predetermined height, and two stepped portions extending by a predetermined width along the outer circumference of the coupling portion (see FIG. **11**). The blade portions **53d** of the first coupler **50** may be in contact with the projection between the two stepped portions of the first central plate **11**.

(213) The first coupler **50** supports the first central plate **11** through the blade portions **53d**. As described above, the movement of the first central plate **11** may be prevented by the elastic force.

(214) The first coupling portion **51** and the first close-contact portion **52** of the first coupler **50** may define a predetermined space into which the coupling portion of the first central plate **11** may be fitted. Referring to FIG. **14**, an end of the first close-contact portion **52** may be spaced apart from the first central plate **11** at a predetermined interval. That is, a length of the first close-contact portion **52** may be smaller than a height of the coupling portion of the first central plate **11**.

Therefore, a part of the coupling portion of the first central plate **11** is not in direct contact with the first close-contact portion **52** and may not receive the stress from the rotary shaft **15**.

(215) Referring to FIGS. **15A** and **15B**, the shape of the first support portion **53** of the first coupler **50** may be changed depending on the states before and after the first coupler **50** is coupled to the rotary shaft **15** and the first central plate **11**.

(216) In more detail, the first support portion **53** includes the wrinkled portion **53c** which is flexibly deformable in shape vertically, and the blade portion **53d** formed upward at a predetermined angle at the outer peripheral end of the first support portion **53**. The blade portion **53d** is disposed upward at a predetermined angle so as to have the highest load per unit length of the first support portion **53**. Therefore, the first support portion **53** has a high load at the outer periphery at which the blade portion **53d**, and the wrinkled portion **53c** may move vertically and be inclined downward by its own weight before the first coupler is coupled to the rotary shaft **15** and the first central plate **11** (see FIG. **15A**).

(217) In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **15B**, the state in which the first coupler **50** is coupled to the first central plate **11** and the rotary shaft **15** is illustrated. The second support ends **53b** of the first support portions **53** may be supported by and in close contact with the first central plate **11** to define a flat plate shape.

(218) In more detail, the second support ends **53b** of the first support portions **53** may be supported by the first central plate **11**. The coupling force between the first central plate **11** and the rotary shaft **15** may be higher than the weights of the second support ends **53b** and the weights of the blade portions **53d**, thereby moving the second support ends **53b** upward. Therefore, the first support portions **53** may be deformed in a flat plate shape and be in close contact with the first central plate **11**.

(219) As described above, the first support portion **53** is configured such that the shape thereof may be deformed depending on the states before and after the first coupler is coupled to the rotary shaft **15** and the first central plate **11**. Therefore, the first support portions **53** may be in close contact with the first central plate **11**.

(220) In addition, when the first central plate **11** moves vertically, the second support ends **53b** may move vertically to correspond to the vertical movement of the first central plate **11**, thereby maintaining the contact between the first central plate **11** and the first support portions **53**.

(221) Further, the wrinkled portions **53c** may generate the rotational elastic force for the restoration to the initial shape, such that the second support ends **53b** may prevent the vertical movement of

the first central plate **11**.

(222) Because the second coupler **60** and the first coupler **50** are identical in structure and function to each other, the description of the second coupler **60** may be replaced with the description of the first coupler **50**.

(223) While the present disclosure has been described with reference to the specific embodiments, the specific embodiments are only for specifically explaining the present disclosure, and the present disclosure is not limited to the specific embodiments. It is apparent that the present disclosure may be modified or altered by those skilled in the art without departing from the technical spirit of the present disclosure.

(224) All the simple modifications or alterations to the present disclosure fall within the scope of the present disclosure, and the specific protection scope of the present disclosure will be defined by the appended claims.

DESCRIPTION OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

(225) **1**: Robot cleaner **10**: First rotary plate **11**: First central plate **12**: Second outer peripheral plate **13**: First spoke **15**: Rotary shaft **15a**: Coupling pin **20**: Second rotary plate **21**: Second central plate **22**: Second outer peripheral plate **23**: Second spoke **25**: Rotary shaft **30**: First mop **40**: Second mop **50**: First coupler **51**: Coupling portion **52**: Close-contact portion **53**: Support portion **53a**: First support end **53b**: Second support end **53c**: Wrinkled portion **54d**: Blade portion **60**: Second coupler **100**: Body **120**: First support wheel **130**: Second support wheel **140**: Auxiliary wheel **150**: Auxiliary wheel body **160**: First actuator **170**: Second actuator **180**: Control part **190**: Bumper **200**: First sensor **210**: Second sensor **220**: Battery **230**: Water container

Claims

1. A robot cleaner comprising: a body configured to define an external appearance, and including a drive motor; a rotary plate to be rotatably coupled to the body, and the rotary plate having a lower portion to which a mop is to be coupled; and a coupler to couple between the body and the rotary plate, wherein the rotary plate includes: a central plate; a plurality of spokes to couple to an outer circumferential surface of the central plate, each of the spokes to separately extend in a radial direction from the circumferential surface of the central plate; an outer peripheral plate to connect to the plurality of spokes and to radially extend by a predetermined width; and a rotary shaft configured to rotate the central plate, and wherein the coupler includes: a coupling portion having a space to be penetrated by the rotary shaft; a plurality of support portions to couple to an outer circumferential surface of the coupling portion, each of the support portions to separately extend outward from the outer circumferential surface of the coupling portion; and a close-contact portion to extend from the space of the coupling portion and to have surface contact with the rotary shaft, and the close-contact portion made of metal has elasticity to reduce swaying of the rotary shaft.
2. The robot cleaner of claim 1, wherein the support portions are configured to extend radially and be radially aligned with the spokes.
3. The robot cleaner of claim 2, wherein the support portion comprises: a first support end to extend from the outer circumferential surface of the coupling portion, and the first support end to contact an upper portion of the central plate; and a second support end to couple to an outer end of the first support end, and wherein the second support end is disposed to have a level difference from the first support end.
4. The robot cleaner of claim 3, wherein the support portion comprises a blade portion to extend from an outer end of the second support end, and wherein the blade portion is to be inclined upward from the second support end and is configured to support a protruding projection of the central plate.
5. The robot cleaner of claim 3, wherein the second support end is inclined downward from the first support end.

6. The robot cleaner of claim 2, wherein the support portions include a plurality of flat plates each having a width that decreases outward in the radial direction from the coupling portion.
7. The robot cleaner of claim 1, wherein the coupler includes a close-contact portion to extend downward from an inner end of the coupling portion.
8. The robot cleaner of claim 7, wherein the close-contact portion is configured to be in surface contact with an outer surface of the rotary shaft.
9. The robot cleaner of claim 8, wherein the close-contact portion includes a plurality of flat springs to extend downward from the inner end of the coupling portion.
10. The robot cleaner of claim 9, wherein the plurality of flat springs are spaced apart from each other.
11. The robot cleaner of claim 4, wherein the blade portion is made of a metal, and the blade portion is configured to provide an elastic force for mitigating stress to be provided to the central plate.
12. A robot cleaner comprising: a body; a rotary shaft; a rotary plate to couple to the rotary shaft so as to be rotated, and the rotary plate configured to support a mop for cleaning; and a coupler to couple to the rotary plate, wherein the rotary plate includes: a central plate; an outer plate spaced apart from an outer surface of the central plate; and a plurality of spokes to connect the outer surface of the central plate to the outer plate, each of the spokes to separately radially extend from the outer surface of the central plate to the outer plate; wherein the rotary shaft is configured to rotate the central plate, and wherein the coupler includes: a coupling portion having an inner space in which the rotary shaft is to be provided; and a plurality of support portions to couple to an outer surface of the coupling portion, each of the support portions to separately extend outward from the outer surface of the coupling portion, wherein an outer end of one of the support portions is to be inclined upward to support a protrusion of the central plate.
13. The robot cleaner of claim 12, wherein each of the support portions comprises: a first support part to couple to the outer surface of the coupling portion; a second support part to couple to an outer end of the first support part; and a blade portion to be inclined upward from an outer end of the second support part.
14. The robot cleaner of claim 13, wherein the support portions include a plurality of flat plates each having a width that decreases outward in a radial direction.
15. The robot cleaner of claim 12, wherein the coupler includes a close-contact portion to extend from the inner space of the coupling portion and to have surface contact with the rotary shaft, and configured to reduce swaying of the rotary shaft.
16. The robot cleaner of claim 15, wherein the close-contact portion includes a plurality of flat springs to separately extend downward from the inner space of the coupling portion and to provide a restoring force for the rotary shaft.
17. The robot cleaner of claim 13, wherein the blade portion is made of a metal, and the blade portion is configured to provide an elastic force for mitigating stress to be provided to the central plate.
18. A robot cleaner comprising: a body; a rotary shaft configured to rotate; a rotary plate configured to rotate with respect to the body based on the rotary shaft; and a coupler to couple to the rotary plate, wherein the rotary plate includes a central plate, an outer plate, and a plurality of spokes each to couple to an outer surface of the central plate and to the outer plate; wherein the coupler includes: a coupling portion having an inner space in which the rotary shaft is to pass; a plurality of support portions to couple to the coupling portion and to separately extend outward from the coupling portion such that each of the support portions is to be radially aligned with a corresponding one of the spokes; and wherein the coupler includes a close-contact portion to extend from the inner space of the coupling portion and to have surface contact with the rotary shaft, and the close-contact portion made of metal has elasticity to reduce swaying of the rotary shaft.

19. The robot cleaner of claim 18, wherein each of the support portions comprises: a first support part to couple to the coupling portion; a second support part to couple to an outer end of the first support part; and a blade portion to be inclined upward from an outer end of the second support part, and configured to support a protrusion of the central plate.
